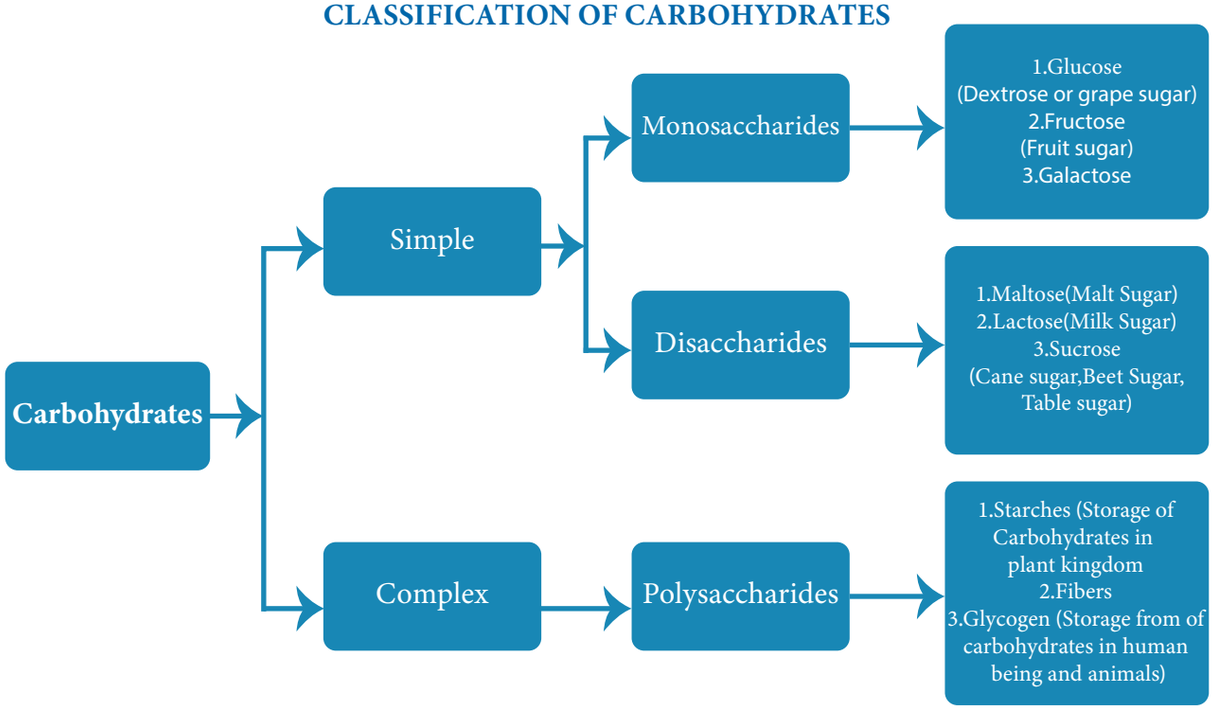
CLASSIFICATION OF CARBOHYDRATES



Dietary sources

The important sources of carbohydrates in the diets are cereals, millets, roots, tubers pulses, sugar and jaggery.

Table: 3

Food	Carbohydrate g / 100 g
Cereals and millets (rice, jowar)	63 – 79
Pulses (Bengl gram, red gram, etc)	50 – 60
Nuts and oilseeds	10 – 25
Roots and tubers	22 – 39
Arrow root flour	85 – 87
Cane sugar	99
Sago	87 – 89
Honey	79 – 80
Jaggery	94 – 95
Milk	4 – 5
Dried fruits	67 – 77
Fresh fruits	10 - 25

Functions

1. Supply energy for body functions and for doing work. Each gram of carbohydrate yield 4 kcal of energy.
2. Essential for the oxidation of fats
3. Exert a sparing action on proteins.
4. Provide carbon skeleton for the synthesis of some non – essential amino acids.
5. Add flavor to the diet.

Digestion, absorption and storage, metabolism of carbohydrates

The first stage of digestion takes place in the mouth while the food is chewed. In saliva the enzyme called alpha – amylase which is called as ptyalin acts on starch. The enzyme acts on starch splitting it into dextrin and maltose. As soon as the food reaches the stomach it mixes with acidic gastric juices for digestion. The main digestion takes place in the intestines.

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